44 Network Administrator Interview Questions (With Example Answers)

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Video: Becoming a Network Systems Administrator

Are you interested in a career as a Network Systems Administrator but are not sure how to start preparing for it? We have you covered!

KEY TAKEAWAYS:

- There are common questions interviewers can ask to find out about your experience as well as how much you understand about the network administration industry.
- Network administrators carry the responsibility of configuring, maintaining and upgrading servers and networks for one or more companies.
- Before your interview, studying the different terms and protocols regarding network administration can help you show the interviewer that you understand what you need to know for the position.

Network administrators carry the responsibility of configuring, maintaining and upgrading servers and networks for one or more companies. There are common questions interviewers can ask to find out about your experience as well as how much you understand about the network administration industry. Knowing these possible questions can help you prepare your answers for the interview. In this article, we list 44 common network administration interview questions and provide example answers to help you craft your own.

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Network administrator Hiring Insights

Average pay

$84,444 / year

Low $26,000 **High** $176,000

Job seekers

23,852

+46 since August 2026

Employers hiring

628

+628 with open roles this month

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General questions

These questions help the interviewer determine your personality and interest in the job:

- Why do you want to work for our company as a network administrator?
- What made you want to work in network administration?
- What are your hobbies outside of work?
- What words would someone use to describe you?
- What is your greatest strength?
- What is your greatest weakness?
- What has been your favorite network administration job?
- What do you like most about network administration?
- What do you dislike most about network administration?
- Are there any skills or tasks you need to improve on?

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Questions about experience and background

These questions help the interviewer understand more about your background and experience in the network administration field:

- How has your previous network administration position prepared you for this job?
- Have you ever worked as a network administrator before?
- What types of networks do you have the most experience working with?
- What monitoring approaches and tools do you prefer using?
- Are you familiar with workgroups?
- Are you familiar with domains?
- What has been your most challenging network administration experience?
- What network administrator task do you enjoy the most?
- Have you received any certifications for network administration?
- What training have you received in network administration?

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In-depth questions

Your answers to these in-depth questions can help the interviewer understand your extensive knowledge about network administration:

- Can you explain how two-factor authentication is used?
- What are some examples of strong password requirements?
- Can you explain what a firewall is and how it can be used?
- What's the difference between a switch and a hub?
- What types of authentication can be used for network access?
- What are IP classes?
- What is the difference between local, global and universal groups?
- Can you explain the ports that are used for HTTP, HTTPS and FTP?
- Can you explain what a proxy server is?

- Can you explain what terminal services are used for?
- What are the benefits of using a simple network management protocol?
- What is an intrusion detection system?
- Can you explain how port forwarding is implemented?
- What's the difference between a domain and a workgroup?
- What is the difference between a multimode and single-mode fiber?
- What's the difference between a network-attached printer and a print server?



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Video: Top Common Interview Questions and Answers

Jenn, an Indeed Career Coach, breaks down the intentions behind employer's questions and shares strategies for crafting strong responses.

Interview questions with sample answers

Here are a few common interview questions and examples of answers you might use when discussing your experience and knowledge related to network administration.

1. How has your previous network administration position prepared you for this job?

This question allows you to explain your previous work experience as a network administrator. For entry-level candidates or those with other professional experience, you can explain what you have done to prepare for this job. Otherwise, you can describe the major factors you learned from your previous network administration job that led you to apply for this position.

Example: *"I gained extensive experience in both workgroups and domains at my previous job. Getting an understanding of both of these types of network administration has prepared me for any type of network administration, and I understand both the server-to-client setup as well as the individual system level."*

2. What has been your most challenging network administration experience?

Your answer to this question shows how you overcame an obstacle on the job. Select one or a few challenges you have faced in your previous network administrator positions, and use the STAR answer technique to explain the **situation** you experienced, the **task** you needed to do, the **action** you took and the **result** that occurred.

Example: *"There was a time when an outside source was attempting to phish our network. I was working with the security team inside our network administration department, and some of our staff were managing different protocols than the rest of us. I brought the team*

together and explained the correct protocol to use, and we managed the security of our network properly."

3. Have you received any certifications or training in network administration?

There are a variety of certifications you can receive in network administration, including CompTIA Network+, CompTIA Security+, CompTIA A+, Cisco CCNA, Cisco CCNP, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate and Microsoft Certified Solutions Expert. Having one or more of these certifications can help show the interviewer your experience and expertise in a variety of network administration duties.

In your answer, consider listing the certifications you do have and explain how you use them on the job. If you lack certification, you can explain the training you have received or the experience you have in the network administration field in addition to expressing your interest in pursuing certification in the future.

Example: *"I have a Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate certification and plan to obtain the Microsoft Certified Solutions Expert certification. My previous jobs have provided training that has prepared me for these certification examinations as well as the tasks that I've completed in network administration."*

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4. What is the difference between local, global and universal groups?

Your answer to this question shows the interviewer your knowledge of basic network administration tasks. Before your interview, studying the different terms and protocols regarding network administration can help you show the interviewer that you understand what you need to know for the position. For an effective answer, you can discuss a specific workplace experience in which you performed these tasks successfully.

Example: *"Local groups are distribution or security groups that can contain all three types of groups. A global group can be used in its domain as well as in member servers and workstations. A universal group contains all users and groups from any domain in its forest of members."*

5. What is an intrusion detection system?

This question tests your extensive knowledge about security protocols in the network administration and network security fields. If you are pursuing a job in security within a network administration department, understanding what an intrusion detection system is can show the interviewer that you understand more about security administration. You can also explain a situation in which you worked with this system to further demonstrate your familiarity.

Example: *"An intrusion detection system, or IDS, is similar to an anti-virus program. A network IDS will look for anomalies in a network and will display a security report when anomalies are found."*

6. What is the difference between a switch and a hub?

Knowing the answer to this question is essential for the interviewer to believe you understand the position you are applying for. Aside from your general knowledge, your response can provide insight into how much you know about the difference between switches and hubs.

Example: *"Switches and hubs look roughly the same on the outside and are used to create a network. The most noticeable difference is the way each handles connections. A hub will broadcast all data to every port, whereas a switch creates connections dynamically. Switches raise less concern for security and reliability."*

7. What types of authentication can be used for network access?

Your answer to this question helps the interviewer understand your knowledge about network access and the variety of authentication techniques that can be used. The most important part of your answer might include the need for two-factor authentication for increased security.

Example: *"I believe two-factor authentication is needed for any network access. A network could use a variety of authentication factors, including passwords, PINs, security questions, tokens, email authentication and biometric scans. Increased security networks can use three-factor authentication when needed."*

8. What monitoring approaches and tools do you prefer using?

An interviewer might ask this question to allow you to explain your previous work experience in the network administration field. Use this question to craft an answer that shows what tools and approaches you enjoy and what you might utilize in your potential position.

Example: *"I enjoy network monitoring and infrastructure management and have used many different tools that help manage both of these and more. I've used Idera for most network administration tasks, but Lab Tech is my favorite because of the dashboard customization features."*

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If you're interested in becoming a network administrator or working in the technology industry, here's a list of 10 jobs you may consider:

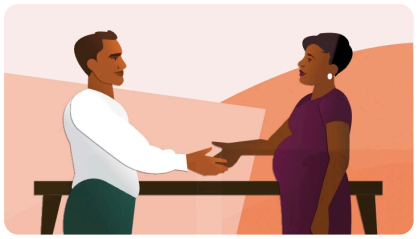
1. Network analyst
2. Field service technician
3. Systems administrator
4. Computer programmer
5. Data scientist
6. Network consultant
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